



Million-dollar NFTs stolen

A hacker managed to break into the project's Instagram page to steal \$1 million of Bored Ape Yacht Club NFTs. <https://dgit.in/may22-19>



Dell goes proprietary

Dell is looking all set to use proprietary DDR5 RAM modules in their laptops, limiting user upgradability. <https://dgit.in/may22-20>

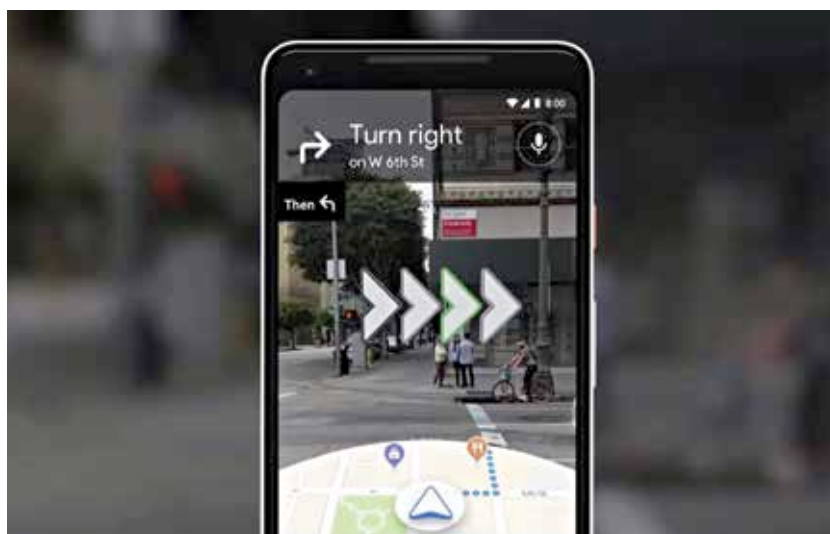
150W charging speeds make their way to a few smartphones this year.

IMPROVED CAMERA EXPERIENCES

In 2021, multiple lens systems and AI image processing for smartphone cameras become commonplace. Improved sensor sizes was also the talk of the town since that meant better images with more detail. Global Mobile Camera Trends 2022 organised by Counterpoint Research held a webinar recently where experts from DXOMARK Image Labs, Samsung and Tecno discussed a few smartphone camera trends in 2022. Amongst the features discussed, the highlights were Dual OIS, high resolution cameras (some touching even 200MP) with pixel binning, advanced optical zoom, and RGBW sensors. 8K video recording will also become more commonplace, and some mid-range smartphones could also offer it this year. Artificial Intelligence will continue to play a vital role in image processing and edge detection.

IN-DISPLAY SELFIE CAMERAS

In-display selfie cameras could be the push needed to achieve the bezel-less screen dream that manufacturers have been working towards for years now. In its current form, in-display selfie cameras aren't very reliable with the footage often coming out looking hazy and lacking details. The selfie camera is topped with an area of low resolu-



tion display in order to allow light to pass through to the sensor. The image quality of phones that have this technology naturally take a hit, but it has improved since the first under-display camera phone – the ZTE Axon 20. Trade pundits forecast that we could see more of such in-display selfie cameras in the second half of 2022 from companies such as Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo and Realme. The technology will hopefully be worked upon and improved in the new models of phones sporting this tech.

MORE 5G READY HANDSETS

While 5G smartphones are no new thing, this year we will definitely see a larger influx of 5G-ready handsets, possibly even in devices costing under ₹10,000. India hasn't seen 5G adoption yet but since it is a couple of years around the corner, you can be sure that 5G phones will become the new norm in 2022 and the coming years, with 4G-only devices being a thing of the past. 5G-capable smartphones will allow for higher-quality video consumption, faster download speeds, stable AR/VR experiences, smoother gaming, and much more. However, we hope that 5G adoption happens sooner rather than later, since people buying phones with 5G capabilities now to be future proof their purchase, may need to upgrade again before 5G even becomes available.

AUGMENTED REALITY AND VIRTUAL REALITY

With the buzz around the Metaverse, it is natural that AR and VR features will be integrated into an increasing number of apps, games and even inbuilt smartphone features. Applications that use AR and VR can enhance the real-world environmental with useful and entertaining digital objects. The applications are endless. Some useful examples of AR and VR integration we can think of include object measurement, navigation, education, interior design and user manuals. Naturally, the production of AR-enabled devices will also increase due to this push.

FAST REFRESH RATE DISPLAYS

There was a time when 90 Hz or 120 Hz refresh rate support was reserved for the premium tier of smartphones but 2021 changed that. Devices priced as low as ₹15,000 sported fast refresh rate displays, allowing users to experience the seamless-ness of speedy refresh rates without breaking the bank. In 2022, we may see some more 144 Hz refresh rate panels hit the market. Additionally, 90 and 120 Hz refresh rates can also make their way to phones below 15K. We could also see LTPO displays that would allow adaptive refresh rate make its way to mid-range and high-end phones. **d**